Ammar Adam

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Education

University of Waterloo — Waterloo, ON
Honours Bachelor of Computing and Financial Management, Co-op — *Sep 2025 — Apr 2029*

Skills

Languages: Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL, C, HCL (Terraform)
Frameworks: FastAPI, React, Next.js, Node.js, Pandas, NumPy, CVXPY, pytest
Tools: GCP (Cloud Run, Cloud SQL, IAM), PostgreSQL, Docker, CI/CD, GraphQL, Ollama, FFmpeg, CapitalIQ

Work Experience

Sagard Holdings — Toronto, ON
AI Engineer (Contract) — *Sep 2026 — Present*
Python, TypeScript, Windows UI Automation, Ollama, GCP
- Lead rollout of a 6-tool Legal AI Hub across a 20-person Legal team, moving pilots toward team-wide adoption
- Extend Doppel, a local-LLM computer-use agent that infers repeatable workflows from screen and UI context
- Built its execution layer with Windows UI Automation and browser control, avoiding per-app integrations

AI Engineering Intern — *May 2026 — Aug 2026*
Python, TypeScript, FastAPI, React, PostgreSQL, GCP, Terraform, Gemini, Athennian API
- Partnered with Legal & Compliance at a $46B AUM asset manager to scope, build, and ship AI tools into production
- Cut KYC package preparation from weeks to hours by resolving fund entities through Athennian and compiling documents
- Built FAQ Oracle over the team's external-counsel email corpus, turning correspondence into a searchable legal knowledge base
- Owned GCP/Terraform infrastructure and keyless CI/CD across Cloud Run, Cloud SQL, IAM, and GitHub Actions

DataStealth — Mississauga, ON
Product Engineering Intern — *Jul 2025 — Aug 2025*
Python, TypeScript, React
- Shipped a demo environment spanning 8 product capabilities, cutting sales-demo setup from months to hours
- Automated competitor comparisons from 10,000-word research documents, reducing product research time by ~40%

Projects

RocketShip | *Python, FastAPI, Next.js, DeepSeek, NewsAPI, CVXPY*
- Architected an equity research system combining screening, 5-agent LLM debate, live news, and portfolio optimization
- Built forward-return evals and purged walk-forward tests to measure ranking signal, optimizer value, and backtest validity
- Found a sector-neutral momentum baseline beat the LLM ranking model, exposing inflated backtests and optimizer failures

Waze Voice SDK | *Python, FFmpeg, Demucs, OpenAI, ElevenLabs*
- Reverse-engineered Waze's undocumented voice protocol, deriving its 43-file schema, distance mapping, and size constraints
- Productized findings into an open-source CLI spanning TTS, source separation, normalization, route QA, and export
- Built round-trip validation catching missing, silent, misnamed, or modified files; shipped 7 verified voice packs

CanadaClip | *Next.js, TypeScript, Supabase, Auth0, Gemini*
- Co-built an iOS App Clip routing big-brand product links to alternatives from Canadian small businesses
- Engineered merchant onboarding, Gemini product matching, and real-time storefront synchronization

Leadership

Techyon (Hack the North, Waterloo Tech Week) | Organizer
- Designed Hack the North's application and selection rubric, shaping admissions for Canada's largest hackathon
- Organized Waterloo Tech Week across 70 events; raised $6K+ and secured sponsorship from Citadel, HRT, and Shopify
- Moderated a founder panel and a fireside chat; ran speaker and sponsor outreach across 60+ companies

Waterloo Venture Group | Partner Innovation Lead
- Build startup partnerships across a 1,300+ member ecosystem that has placed 30+ students into startups
- Support portfolio founders with market research and partner introductions, including Smoov's expansion beyond the US

Pear VC | Fellow
- One of ~50 selected from 650+ applicants across 17 campuses; source and evaluate early-stage startups and founder talent

OpenAI | Founding Builder Lead
- One of 5 selected across North America; scout student builders and grow adoption of OpenAI developer tools

Awards & Interests

Awards: Valedictorian (Mentor College), DECA International Finalist, FBLA National Champion, Best Delegate (BerkeleyMUN)
Interests: Liverpool FC, NYT Puzzles, Airline Economics, Experiential Architecture, Golf, LEGO, Chicken Shawarma